



THE UNIVERSITY OF
SYDNEY

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To whomever it may concern

I am writing in support of Yi (Brian) Yao whom I supervised while they undertook BWIL6215: International Industry Placement Program.

BWIL6215 offers students an opportunity to consolidate their knowledge and skills in a professional, international industry context through a structured placement. The unit is designed to allow students to demonstrate their ability to apply and synthesise business concepts while engaged in practical project-based work with a host organisation. This placement requires students to work independently and collaboratively, apply both technical and non-technical skills, and translate theory into practice in a complex organisational environment. It is also worth noting that this unit places considerable emphasis on professionalism, preparation, and effective engagement in an international setting. Specifically, this program takes place in New York, USA during the Winter break. This program is challenging for students as they work intensively over this period whilst adjusting to the climate/culture of New York City.

Brian quickly established themselves as a diligent student with a positive attitude towards the placement and the unit more broadly. They consistently demonstrated strong preparation, commitment to their professional responsibilities, and a clear capacity to work productively with others. Over the course of the placement, Brian demonstrated strong analytical thinking and effective communication skills, engaging constructively with both academic and industry expectations. They approached their placement work carefully and thoughtfully and produced work of a high standard.

More broadly, Brian was diligent in preparation and participation throughout the unit and demonstrated consistent engagement with all required tasks. They managed the



demands of an international professional environment well and conducted themselves in a manner that reflected positively on the University. In my experience, they were for all intents and purposes a very strong student.

Brian's strengths certainly lie in their academic capacity and their adaptability and attitude towards learning. They are a motivated and capable learner who works well in collaborative environments, both as a contributing team member and when required to take initiative. As noted above, they also demonstrated a strong sense of professional responsibility and engagement with the aims of the unit.

I would recommend Brian for your program and believe they would be a valuable member of your institution and broader community. I would be more than happy to speak further or discuss their application at a time that suits.

Yours sincerely,

Dr. Steven David Hitchcock

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